



THESE MYSTERIOUS PEOPLE TRACE THEIR ORIGINS to 11th century

DRUZE

GUARDIANS OF A SECRET RELIGION

Cairo where they began as a reform movement within Islam. Because they do not adhere to the Five Pillars of Islam they are not recognized by

The wise and the ignorant

Druze society is comprised of two groups. While everyone attends the *khalwa* (place of worship) on Thursdays, the majority—the *jubaall*—leave after the first part of the service, while a select few—the *uqqal*—remain for the recitation of religious texts.

THE STATUS OF WOMEN

Women are considered to be more spiritual than men because it is assumed that they have less contact with secular society. While women may be initiated alongside men, it is rare to find a woman who has been permitted to get her driving license.



Druze women work mostly in the home and sometimes in fields nearby.



THE UQQAL

Only the most pious and wise men and women belong to the *uqqal*, and even then only after a lengthy period of candidacy. Within the *uqqal*, the most honored group are the *ajaweed* (the good), who possess religious and legal authority.



WHAT THE WISE WEAR

Uqqal men wear a distinctive white hat and a long dark robe. Weaving is an important craft in Druze villages because some very devout Druze only wear clothes made out of handwoven fabric. One Druze sect is known as “the blues” because they wear only hand-dyed and handwoven blue garments.

